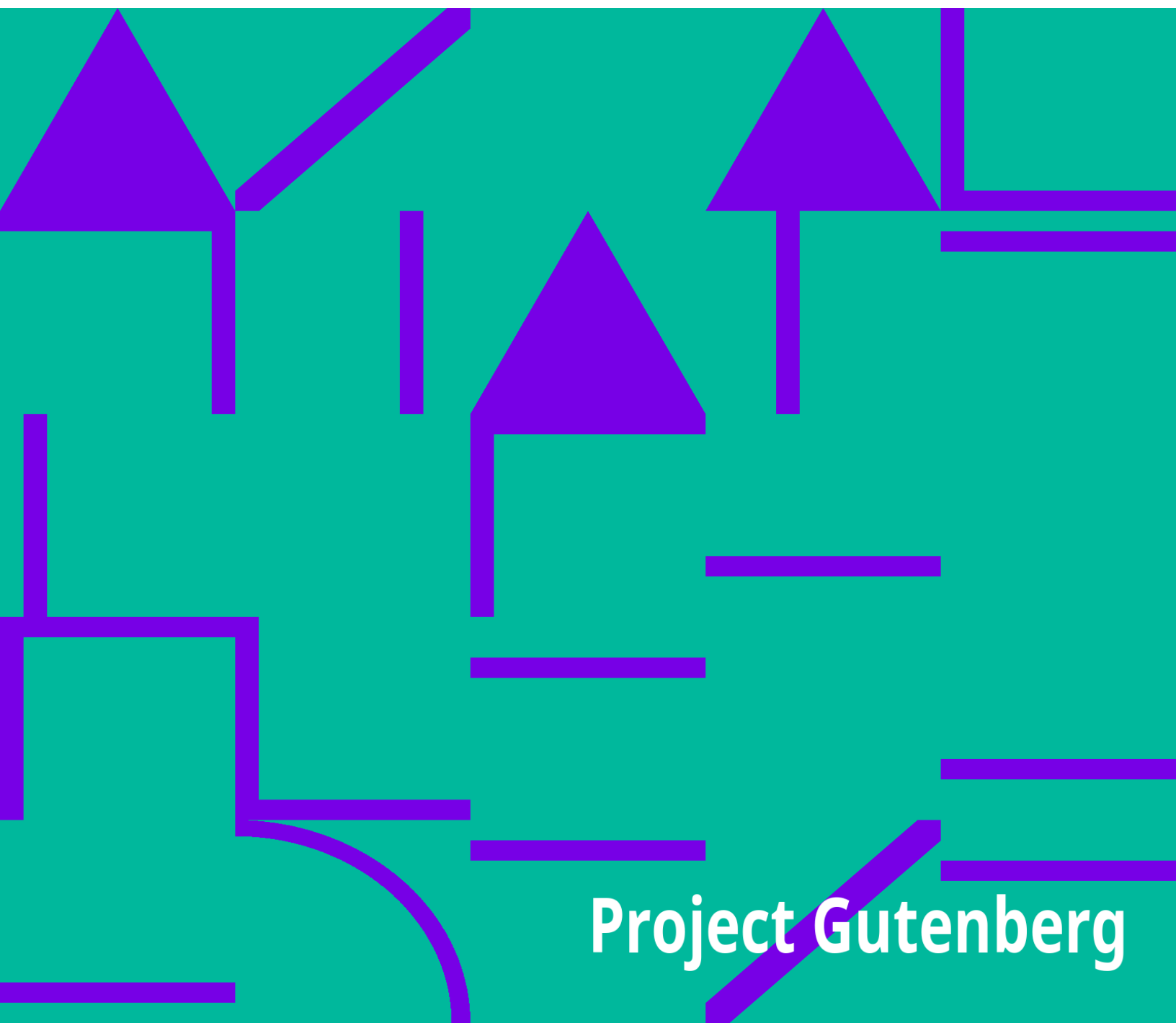


An Alphabet of Old Friends

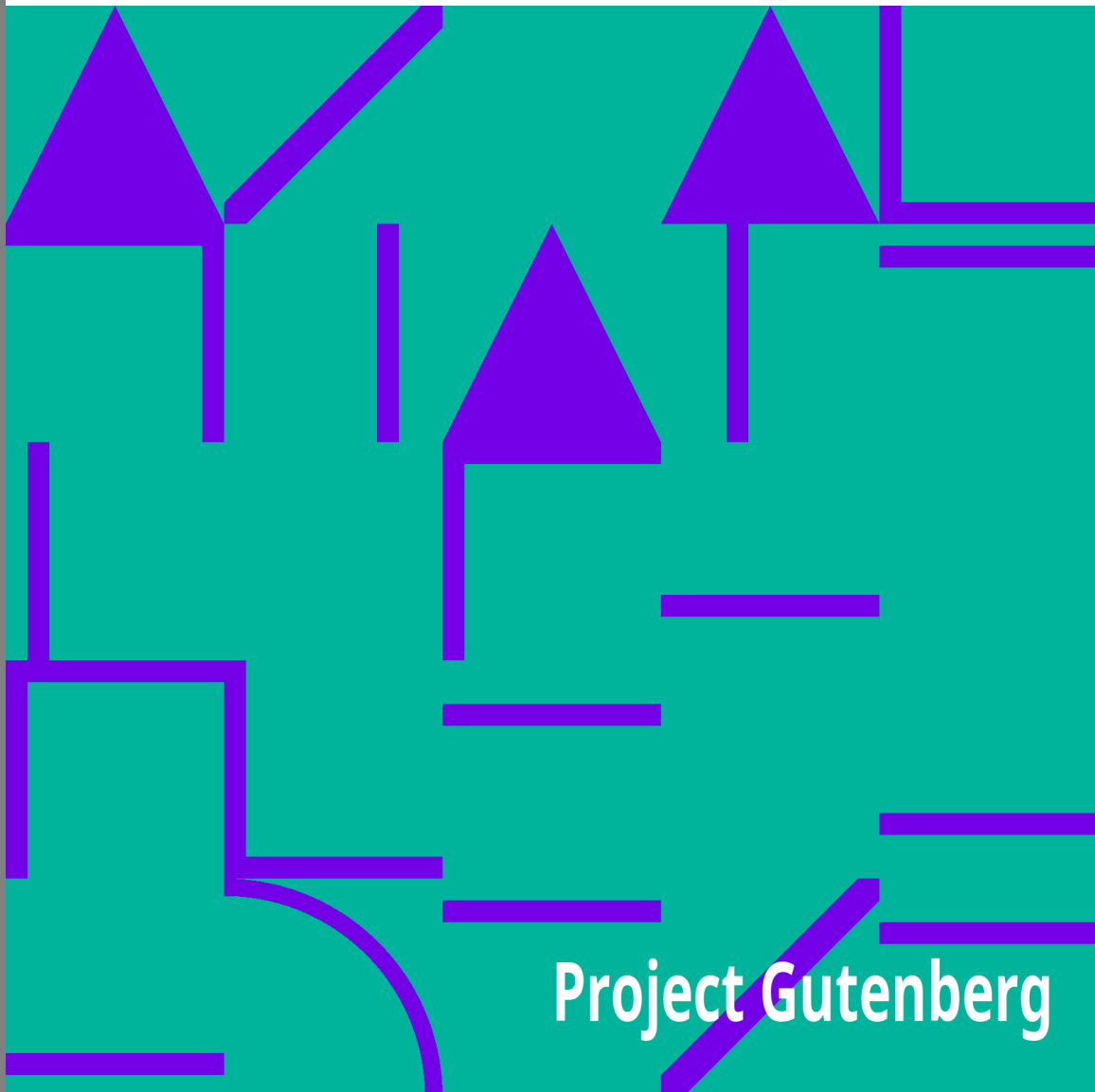
Walter Crane



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An Alphabet of Old Friends

Walter Crane



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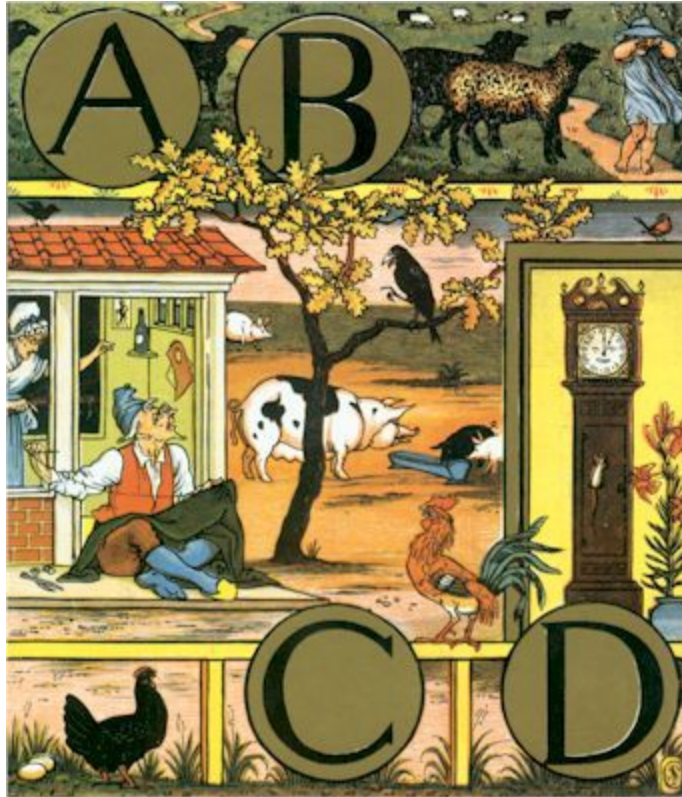


**AN ALPHABET
OF OLD FRIENDS**

by Walter Crane

An alphabet of old friends originally published 1874;

AN ALPHABET OF OLD FRIENDS



A carrion crow sat on an oak,
Watching a tailor shape his cloak.
"Wife, bring me my old bent bow,
That I may shoot yon carrion
crow."

— : The tailor he shot and missed his
mark,

And shot his own sow quite
through the heart.

"Wife, wife, bring brandy in a
spoon,
For our old sow is in a swoon."

Ba, ba, black sheep,
Have you any wool?
Yes, marry, have I,
Three bags full.
One for my master,
One for my dame,
But none for the little boy
That cries in the lane.

Hen. Cock, cock, I have la-a-ayed!

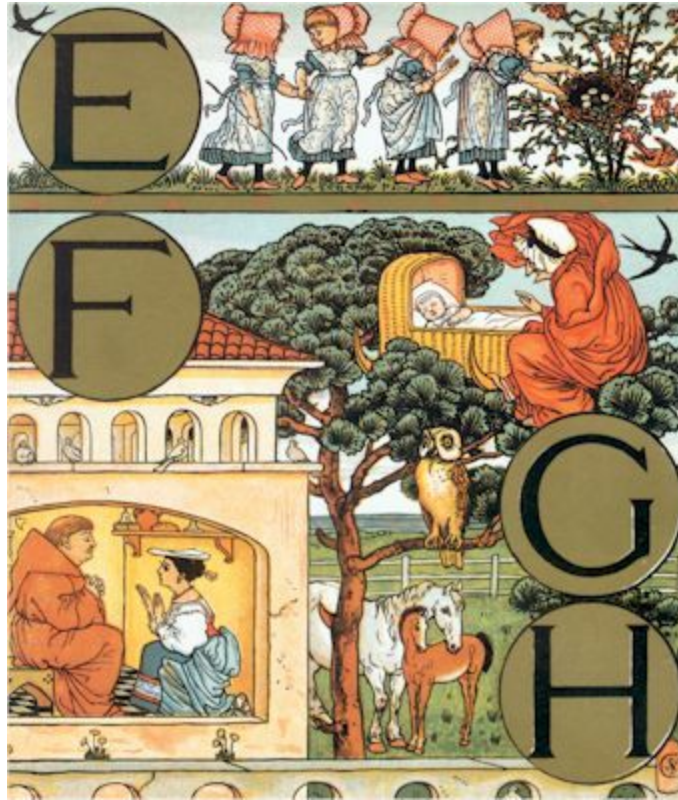
Cock. Hen, hen, that's well sa-a-ayed!

Hen. Although I have to go bare-footed every day-a-ay!

Cock. (Con spirito.) Sell your eggs and buy shoes!

Sell your eggs
and buy shoes!

Dickery, dickery, dock,
The mouse ran up the clock.
The clock struck one,
Down the mouse ran,
Dickery, dickery, dock.



Elizabeth, Elspeth, Betsy, and
Bess,

They all went together to seek a
bird's nest

They found a bird's nest with five
eggs in;

They all took one, and left four in.

Father, father, I've come to
confess.

O, yes, dear daughter, what have
you done?

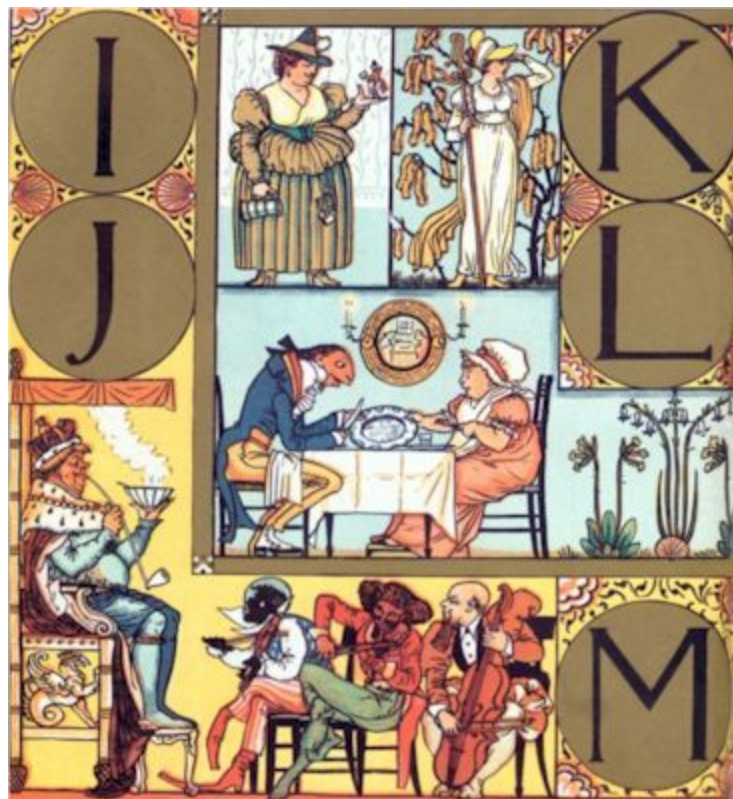
Gang and hear the owl yell,
Sit and see the swallow flee,

See the foal before its mither's e'e,
'Twill be a thriving year wi' thee.

Hush-a-bye, baby, on the tree-top;
When the wind blows the cradle
will rock;

When the wind ceases the cradle
will fall,

And down will come baby and
cradle and all.



I had a little husband
No bigger than my thumb;
I put him in a pint pot,
And there I bade him drum.
I bought a little horse
That galloped up and down;

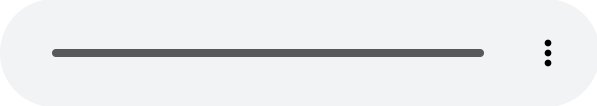
I bridled him, and saddled him,
And sent him out of town.
I gave him a pair of garters,
To tie up his little hose,
And a little silk handkerchief,
To wipe his little nose.



Jack Sprat would eat no fat,
His wife would eat no lean;
Was not that a pretty trick
To make the platter clean?

King Cole was a merry old soul,
And a merry old soul was he.
He called for his pipe, and he
called for his bowl,

And he called for his fiddlers
three

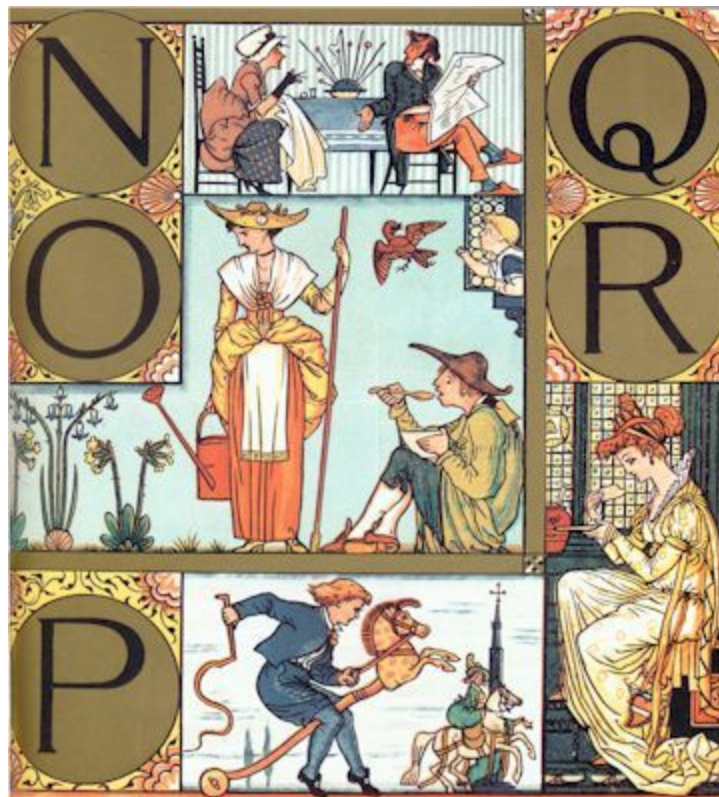


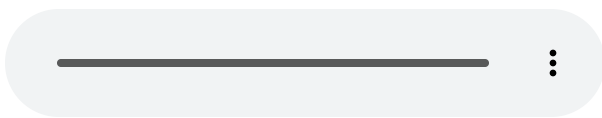
Every fiddler had a fiddle,
And a very fine fiddle had he;
Twee, tweedle dee, tweedle dee,
went the fiddlers.

Oh, there's none so rare
As can compare
With King Cole and his fiddlers
three!

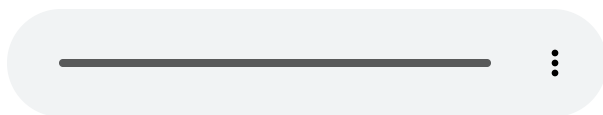
Little Bo-peep has lost her sheep,
And can't tell where to find them.
Let them alone and they'll come
home,
And bring their tails behind them,
&c.

Mistress Mary,
Quite contrary,
How does your garden grow?
With silver bells,
And cockle shells.
And cowslips all of a-row.

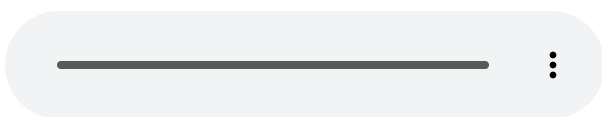




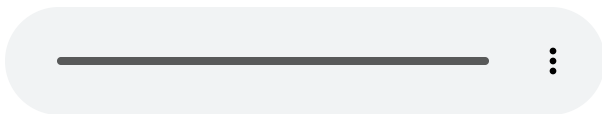
Needles and pins, needles and
pins,
When a man marries his trouble
begins.



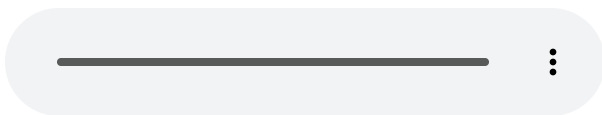
Once I saw a little bird,
Come hop, hop, hop;
So I cried, "Little bird,
Will you stop, stop, stop?"
And was going to the window,
To say, "How do you do?"
When he shook his little tail,
And far away he flew.



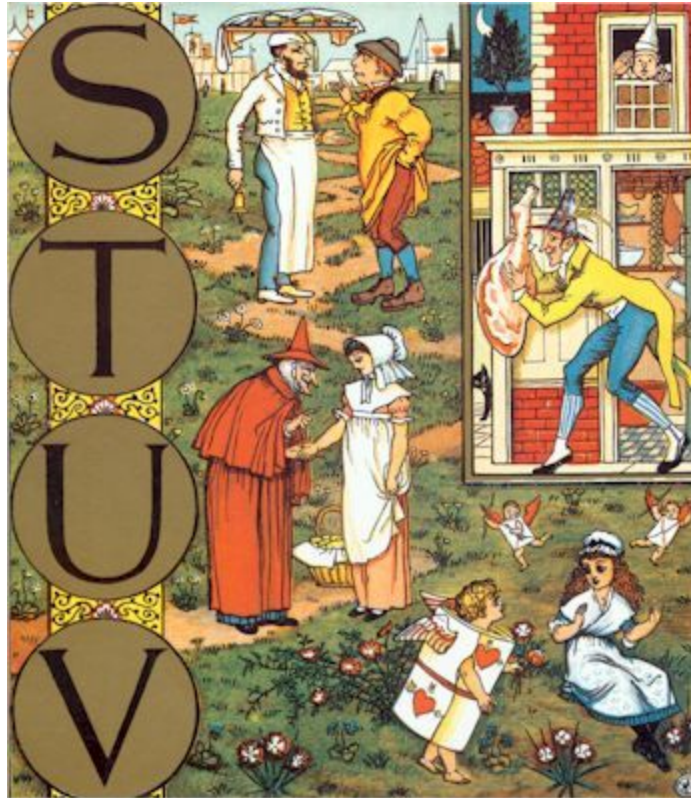
Pease-pudding hot, pease-pudding
cold;
Pease-pudding in the pot, nine
days old.



Queen was in the parlour, eating
bread and honey.



Ride a-cock horse to Banbury
Cross,
To see an old woman get up on her
horse;
Rings on her fingers and bells at
her toes,
And so she makes music wherever
she goes.



_____ :

Simple Simon met a pieman,
Going to the fair;
Says Simple Simon to the pieman,
"Let me taste your ware!"

_____ :

Taffy was a Welshman,
Taffy was a thief,
Taffy came to my house,
And stole a leg of beef.

I went to Taffy's house,
Taffy was not at home;
Taffy came to my house,
And stole a marrow-bone.

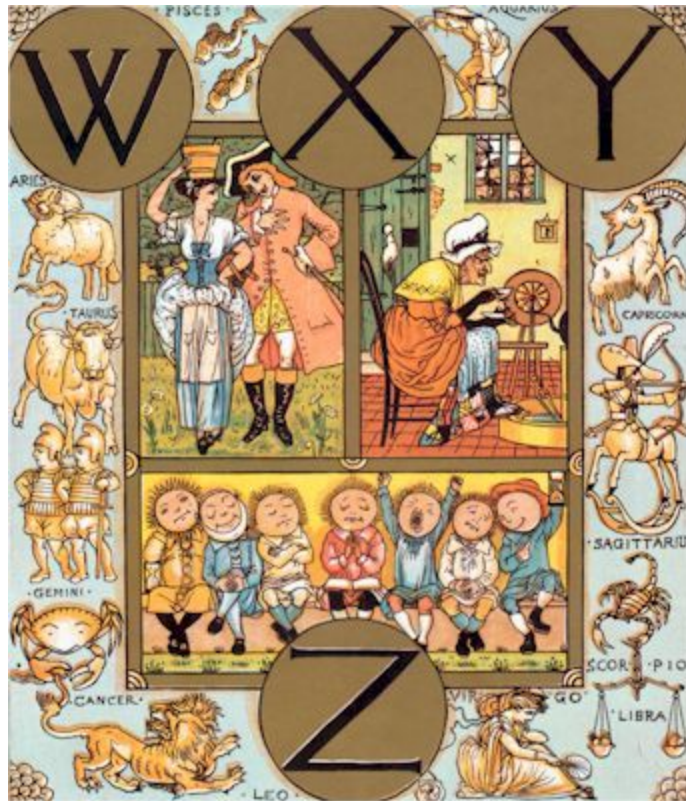
I went to Taffy's house,
Taffy was in bed;

I took the marrow-bone,
And broke Taffy's head.



Up hill and down dale,
Butter is made in every vale;
And if Nancy Cock
Is a good girl,
She shall have a spouse,
And make butter anon,
Before her old grandmother
Grows a young man.

Valentine, Oh, Valentine,
Curl your locks as I do mine;
Two before and two behind;
Good-morrow to you, Valentine.



_____ :

"Where are you going, my pretty maid?"
 "I'm going a milking, sir," she said.
 "May I go with you, my pretty maid?"
 "You're kindly welcome, sir," she said.
 "What is your father, my pretty maid?"
 "My father's a farmer, sir," she said.
 "Say will you marry me, my pretty maid?"
 "Yes, if you please, kind sir," she said.
 "What is your fortune, my pretty maid?"
 "My face is my fortune, sir," she

said.

"Then, I won't marry you, my pretty maid!"

"Nobody asked you, sir," she said.

Cross X patch,
Draw the latch,
Sit by the fire and spin:
Take a cup
And drink it up,
Then call the neighbours in.

You know that Monday is Sunday's
brother;
Tuesday is such another;
Wednesday you must go to church
and pray;
Thursday is half-holiday;
On Friday it is too late to begin to
spin,
And Saturday is half-holiday again.

ZODIAC FOR THE NURSERY.

The ram, the bull, the heavenly
twins,
And next the crab, the lion shines,
The virgin and the scales,
The scorpion, archer, and the goat,
The man who holds the watering-
pot,
And fish with glittering scales.



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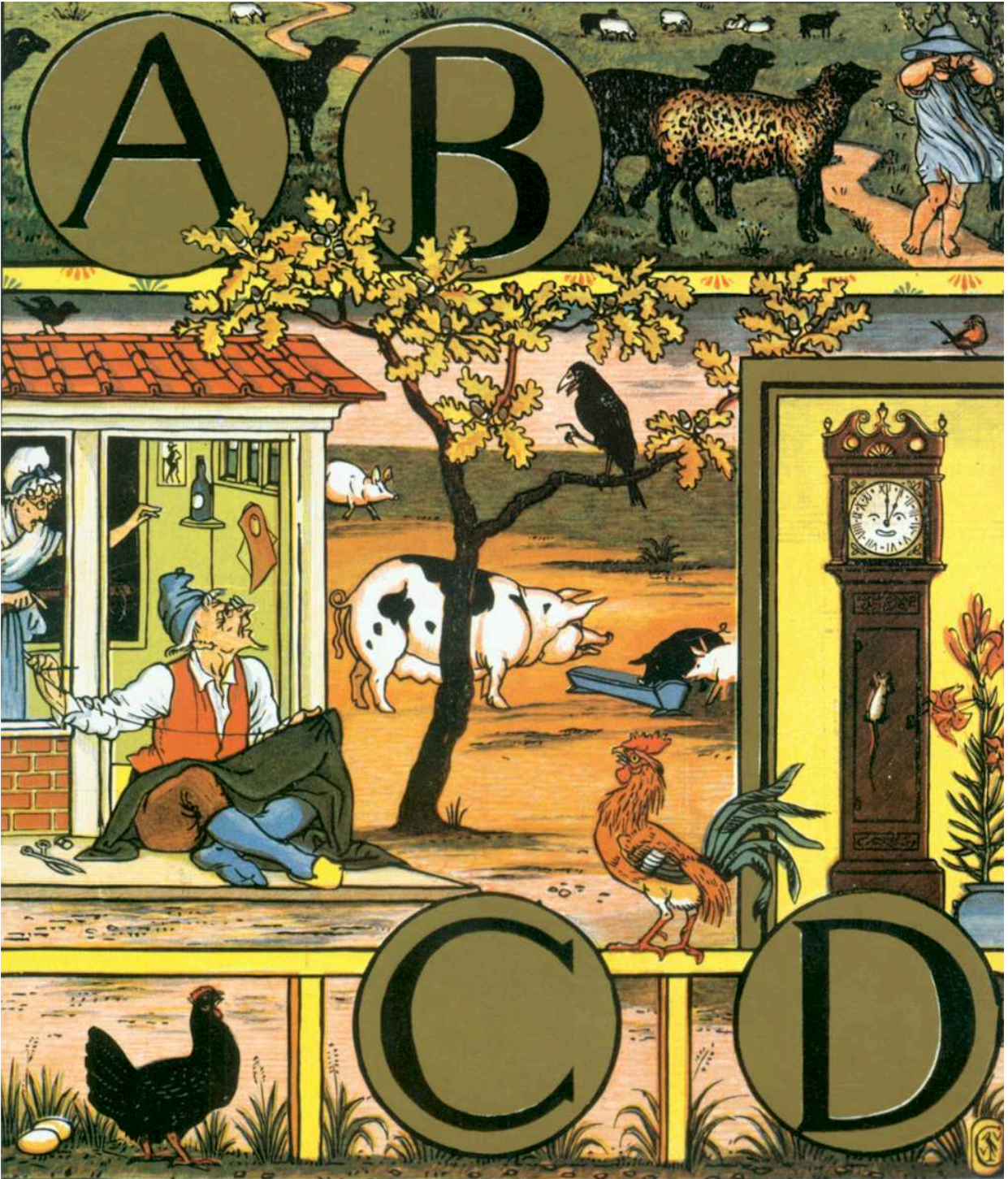
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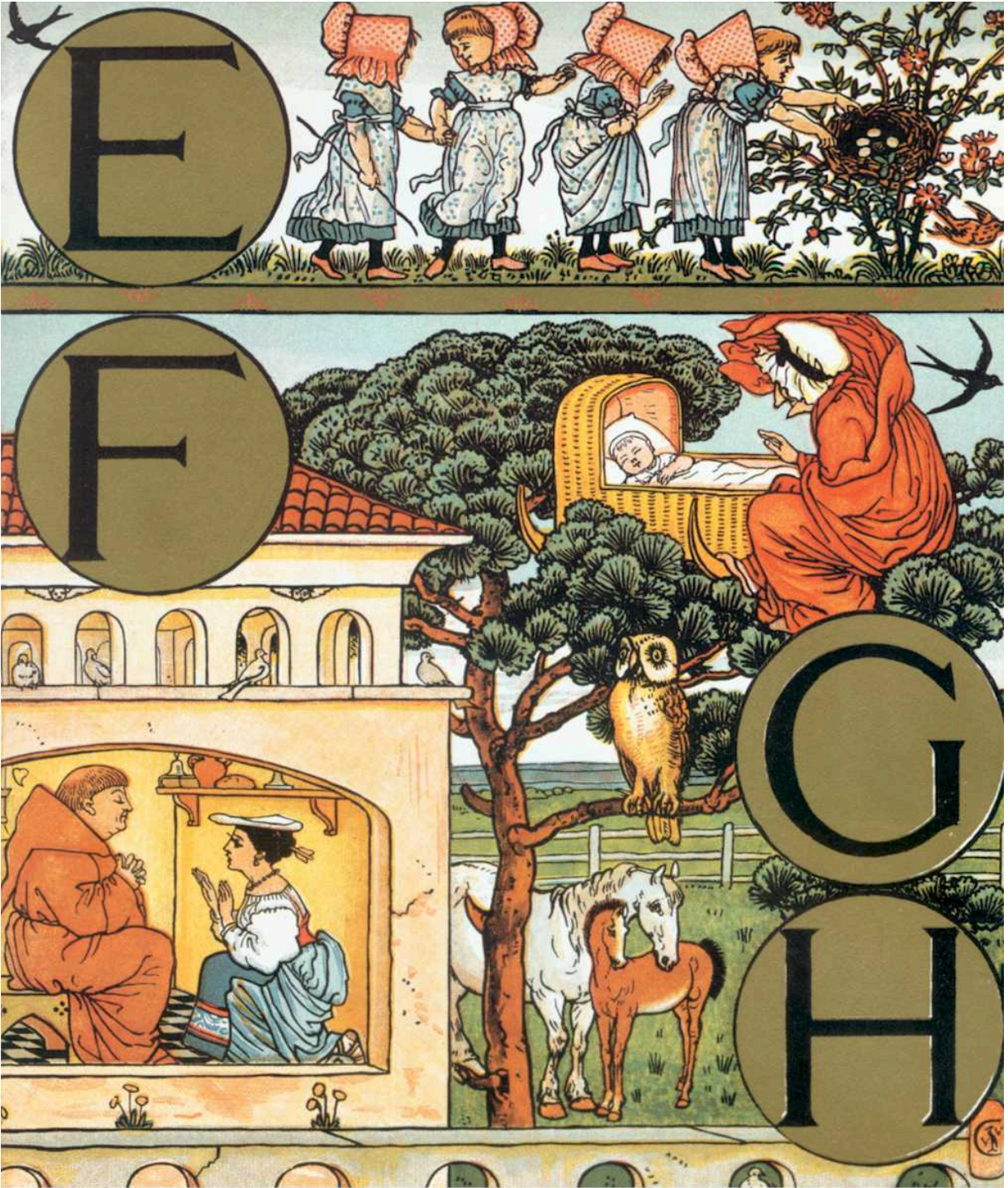
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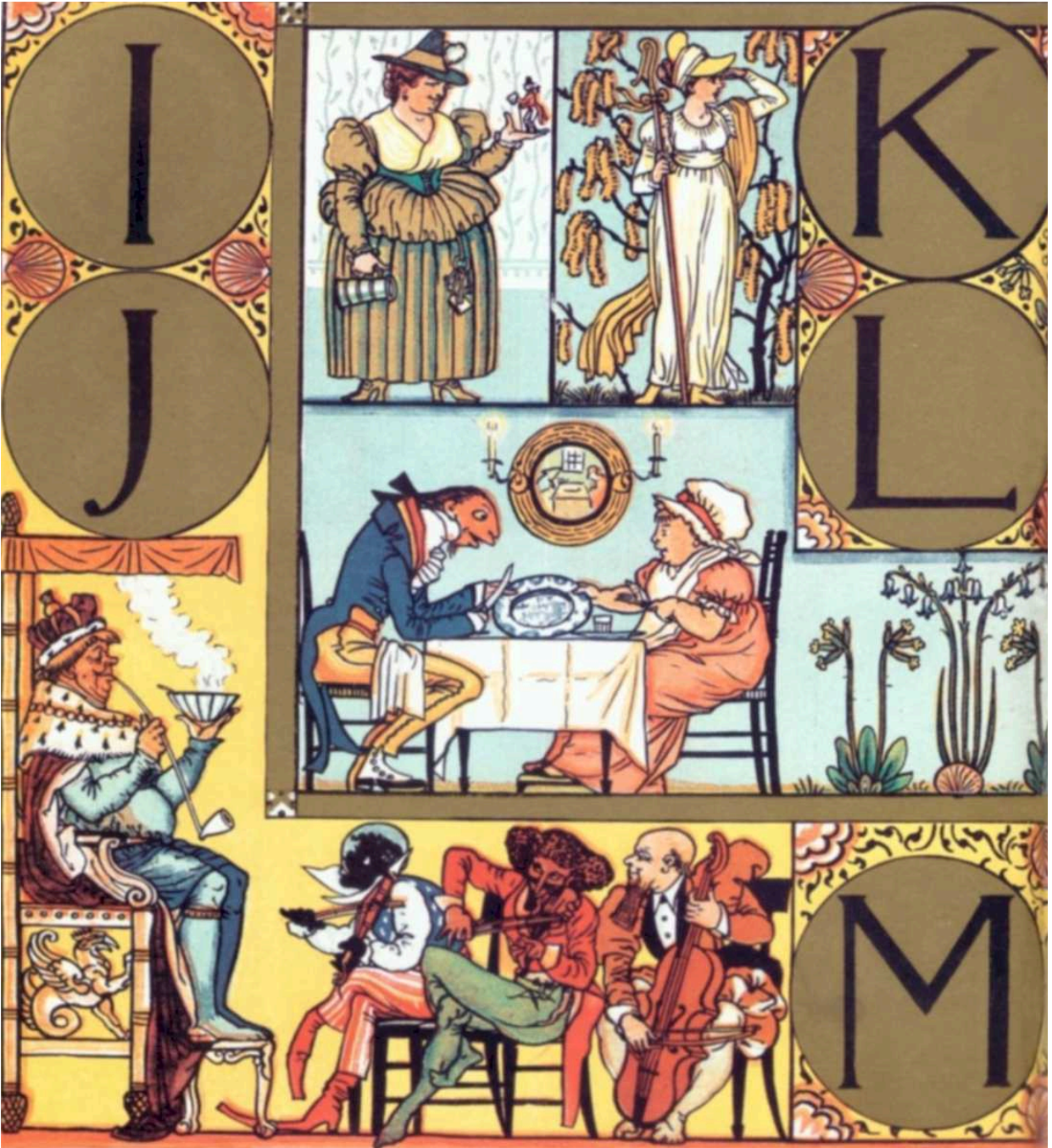
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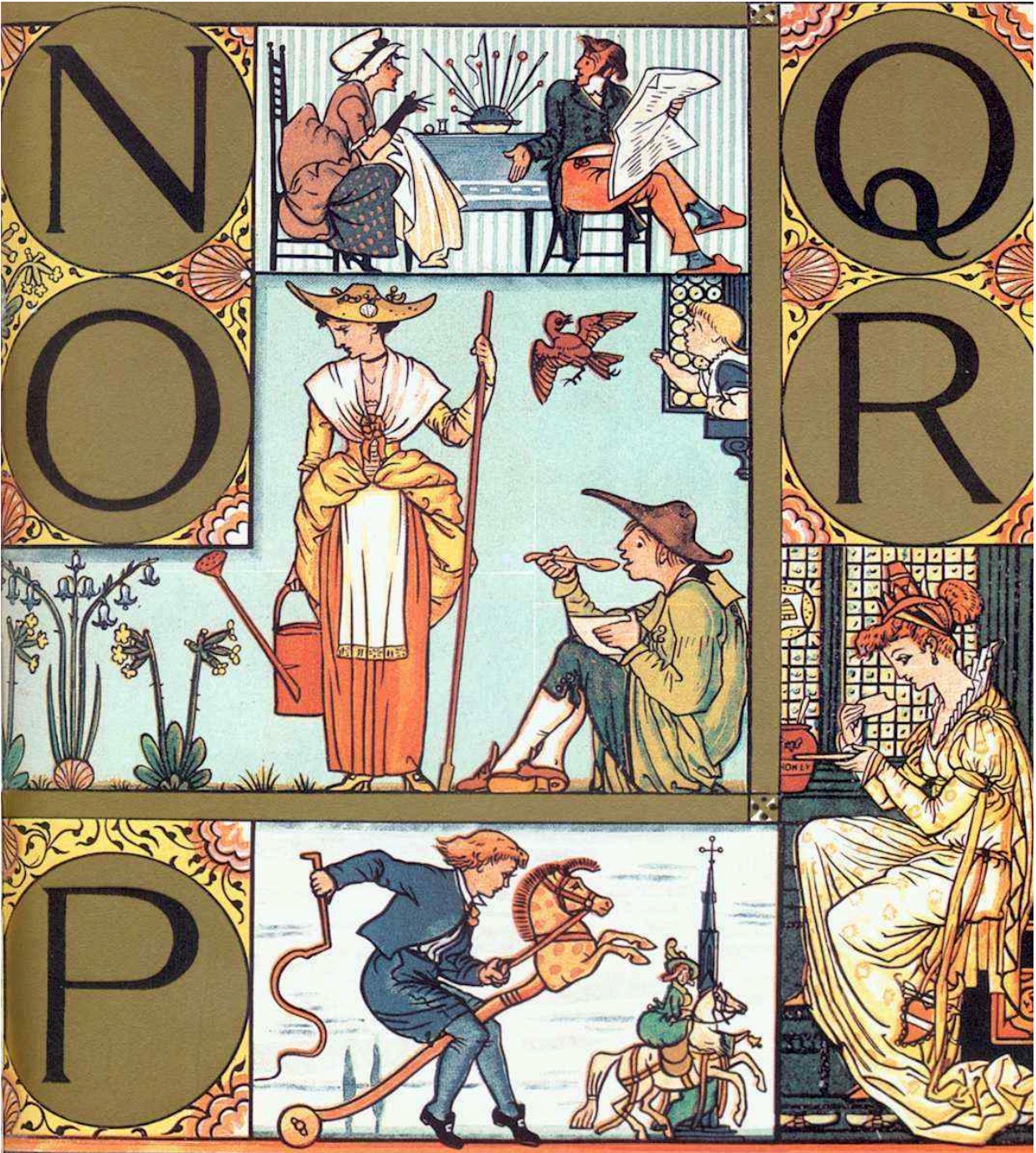
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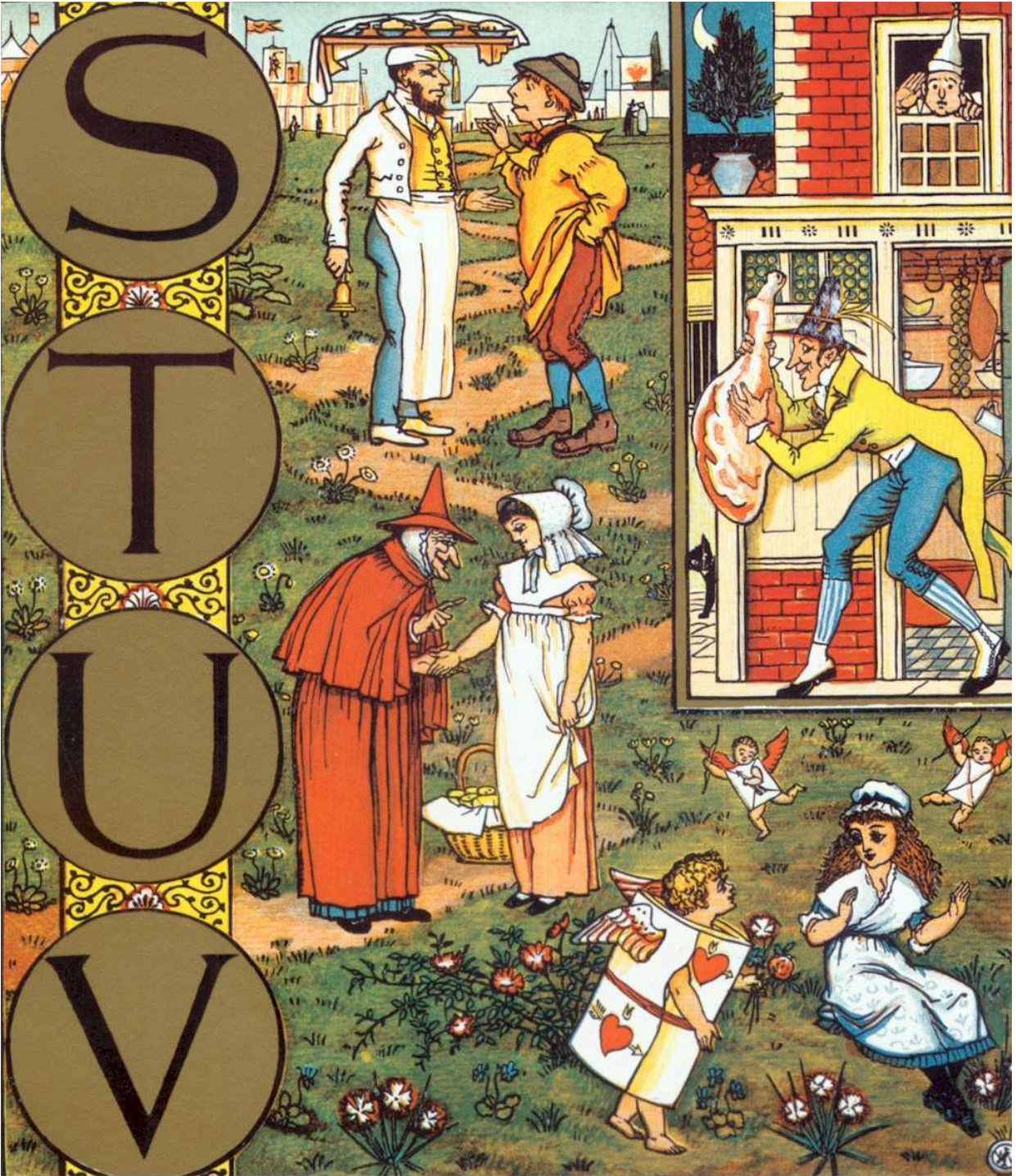
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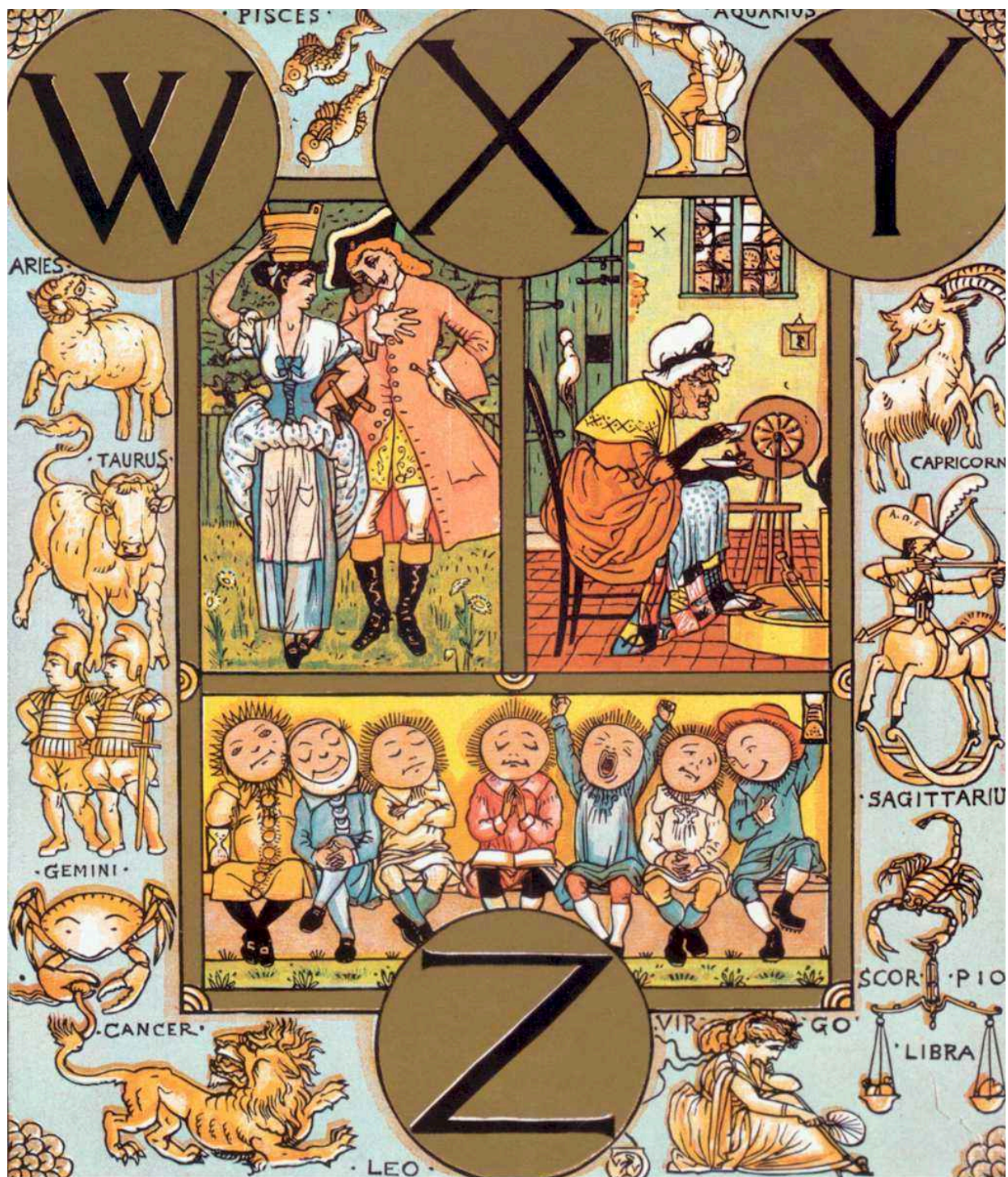
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